

Oppo Reno 16

The best camera smartphone around ₹60000?

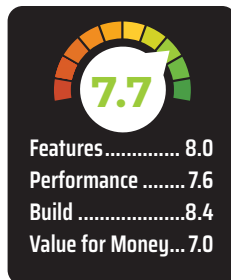
Smartphone brands are packing more and more features into their devices with every new launch. Bigger batteries, high-resolution cameras, brighter displays and AI features have now become common talking points. However, a long list of specifications does not always guarantee a good smartphone experience. What matters is how all these features come together and perform in the real world. The newly launched Oppo Reno 16 comes with a long list of features too, including three 50MP cameras at the back, a massive 6,700mAh battery with 80W fast charging support, the Snapdragon 7 Gen 4 SoC and a 6.32-inch AMOLED display with a 120Hz refresh rate.

All these specs look quite good on paper. But the Oppo Reno 16 starts at Rs 61,999 in India, which puts it in a segment with some serious competition. At this price, buyers have several options that promise top-tier performance and cameras.

So, naturally, the Oppo Reno 16 has a lot to prove. I spent a few weeks using the phone to see where it delivers and where it falls short. Here's my full review.

A VERSATILE CAMERA

In true Oppo fashion, without a shadow of a doubt, cameras are clearly the biggest highlight of the Reno 16. The phone houses a triple 50MP camera setup on the back, comprising a main, an ultrawide and a 3.5x telephoto lens. At the front too, there's a 50MP AF camera for selfies and video calls. And trust me, this is not just a numbers



game. The cameras are actually quite versatile.

Let's start with the 50MP main camera that my colleague and I used the most during our testing. In daylight, the Reno 16 captures detailed and bright photos. There is a slight boost in contrast,

but it does not feel overdone and instead gives photos a punchy, social media-friendly look. Fine details are also preserved well. Textures on buildings, faces, and other objects look sharp when you zoom into the image.

The 50MP ultra-wide camera is another strong part of the setup. It's a better and upgraded sensor from the previous-gen model. Usually, ultra-wide cameras on phones are a clear step down from the main sensor. That is not the case here. The Reno 16 manages

to maintain fairly consistent colours when switching between the main and ultra-wide cameras.

However, my favourite camera on the Reno 16 is the 50MP telephoto camera. It offers 3.5x optical zoom and is one of the phone's biggest strengths. You can stand at a comfortable distance from the subject and still get a close frame. Faces also look more natural compared to portraits shot using the main camera at 1x.

The 3.5x zoom also works particularly well for portrait photos. Edge detection is mostly accurate, even around hair and clothes. The background blur also looks natural.

It does not always have the artificial-looking blur that we see on some smartphones. Skin tones are handled well too.

The telephoto camera is also equally useful in portrait mode. At 3.5x, photos retain plenty of detail. I found myself using this camera to capture graffiti walls, buildings and subjects that were slightly far away.

You can further digitally zoom up to 120x, but image quality starts to drop as you move up the zoom range. Because, just like other phones with insane digital zoom capabilities, at very high zoom levels, the Reno 16 relies heavily on processing. And naturally, fine details start to look soft and artificial. That said, I would still say photos are quite usable at high zoom levels in good light. Just know, if you are looking for the absolute best results, you can simply not go wrong with the 3.5x optical zoom camera.

Interestingly, low-light performance is also good, especially from the main camera. The Reno 16 captures bright photos and manages noise well. Even in low light, the phone brings out a good amount of detail in images.

The 50MP selfie camera also deserves a special mention. It has a wide 100-degree field of view and supports autofocus. The wide frame is especially useful for group selfies. You